SHAME-02 | Therapist only - all age groups

Messages and the context of shame

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Distinguish a shaming message, a feeling of shame, and facts about personal responsibility. Choose a limited situation to discuss and identify a need for support or boundaries without requiring disclosure of a difficult event.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Feeling guilty is not proof of responsibility. Do not hold a harmed person responsible for harm, force confession, or reconstruct trauma. Do not repeatedly check to reach moral certainty; such a pattern needs appropriate professional assessment.

Reusing existing material

SHAME-01 separates feelings and responsibility. Here, identify messages and context; SELF supports a broader self-description but does not replace assessment of harm or responsibility for a particular action.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: After a comment in a group, Tamar thinks she always disturbs others. In the session, she describes one sentence and separates it from a specific behavior that can be explored, without seeking proof of her worth.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What shaming message would I like to explore with the therapist?

2 | Question for discussion

In what situations does it grow stronger, and from whom was it learned?

3 | Question for discussion

How does it affect my interpretation of responsibility?

4 | Question for discussion

What is known about the action, and what cannot be inferred from the feeling?

5 | Question for discussion

What need for protection, clarification, or support arises now?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If a wish to check repeatedly who is to blame appears, stop the repetition and explore its function. Do not promise certainty or turn the form into a confession process.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Choose a small situation that does not require recounting harm. The adult clarifies that a child is not responsible for others' harmful behavior and need not prove their experience on the sheet.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Allow social and family messages to be discussed without requiring names or event details. Check privacy and consent before any sharing.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Distinguish responsibility for an action from generalizations about identity. Explore questions about harm sensitively in a professional setting, not as an exercise in arguing with feelings.

OA | Older adults

Messages from different life periods can be considered without assuming past processing is needed. The participant sets the pace and level of detail.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

One message can be identified only in the session. Searching for memories, contacting its speaker, or keeping a diary of every shaming thought is not required.

At the next session

Check whether a useful distinction emerged and harm or distress needs a response. Shame does not have to disappear for the conversation to be useful.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.nhs.uk/mental-health/self-help/tips-and-support/raise-low-self-esteem/
www.nhs.uk/every-mind-matters/lifes-challenges/maintaining-healthy-relationships-and-mental-wellbeing/

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